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12-Day Devotional

Scripture-shaped reflection through Competition Volume 1.

Sacred Whispers Publishers

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How to Use This Devotional

This devotional is structured for six days of personal reading, reflection, and prayer. Each day follows the same rhythm: a timeless quote, a scripture passage, a reflection, a moment of stillness, action steps, and a closing prayer. Begin on any day of the week. The order within each day is intentional — let each element do its work before moving to the next.

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Week 1 · Day 1

Luke 15:1-2 - All the tax collectors and the sinners were coming near Him to listen to Him

Timeless Wisdom

Though we cannot think alike, may we not love alike?

- John Wesley, Sermons and Tracts

Scripture Reading

Luke 15:1-2 (NASB)

Now all the tax collectors and the sinners were coming near Him to listen to Him. Both the Pharisees and the scribes began to grumble, saying, "This man receives sinners and eats with them."

Reflection

Luke 15:1-2 opens with a scene marked by mercy that welcomes the very people religious pride keeps at a distance. The text does not ask the reader to admire the moment from a distance. The passage puts one clear scene in front of us: All the tax collectors and the sinners were coming near Him to listen to Him. We should stay with that scene before we rush to a slogan. Because this is narrative material, the

Still Before God

- Sit with Luke 15:1-2 for two quiet minutes. Read the scene of mercy that welcomes the very people religious pride keeps at a distance slowly and let it settle before you move on.
- Where does this passage call for glad nearness to Christ that welcomes repentant sinners instead of guarding respectability through distance today?
- Stay for one more minute and answer God with one honest sentence of trust, repentance, or gratitude before continuing.

Walk It Out

Because Luke 15:1-2 calls for glad nearness to Christ that welcomes repentant sinners instead of guarding respectability through distance today:

→ Write one sentence naming how Luke 15:1-2 presses on the scene of All the tax collectors and the sinners were coming near Him to listen to Him.

→ Name one place where glad nearness to Christ that welcomes repentant sinners instead of guarding respectability through distance should change the way you listen, speak, or act today.

Prayer

Father, thank You for speaking clearly in Luke 15:1-2. In this passage You bring mercy that welcomes the very people religious pride keeps at a distance into the open through All the tax collectors and the sinners were coming near Him to listen to Him. Lord Jesus, keep us from reading these words as distant history only, and press them into our ordinary obedience today. Where we resist the truth highlighted in this reflection, bring repentance and renewed trust. Keep us near Your word, and do not let ordinary pressure turn us away from humble

Week 1 · Day 2

Luke 15:3-5 - If he has a hundred sheep and has lost one of them

Timeless Wisdom

Prayer will make a man cease from sin, or sin will entice a man to cease from prayer.

- John Bunyan, A Discourse on Prayer

Scripture Reading

Luke 15:3-5 (NASB)

So He told them this parable, saying, "What man among you, if he has a hundred sheep and has lost one of them, does not leave the ninety-nine in the open pasture and go after the one which is lost until he finds it? When he has found it, he lays it on his shoulders, rejoicing.

Reflection

Luke 15:3-5 opens with a scene marked by seeking mercy that refuses to leave the lost where they wandered. The text does not ask the reader to admire the moment from a distance. The passage puts one clear scene in front of us: If he has a hundred sheep and has lost one of them. We should stay with that scene before we rush to a slogan.

Because this is narrative material, the theology arrives through events.

Still Before God

- Sit with Luke 15:3-5 for two quiet minutes. Read the scene of seeking mercy that refuses to leave the lost where they wandered slowly and let it settle before you move on.
- Where does this passage call for hopeful pursuit that reflects the shepherd's joy in recovering the lost rather than writing them off today?
- Stay for one more minute and answer God with one honest sentence of trust, repentance, or gratitude before continuing.

Walk It Out

Because Luke 15:3-5 calls for hopeful pursuit that reflects the shepherd's joy in recovering the lost rather than writing them off today:

→ Before your next decision, pause and ask how Luke 15:3-5 should shape your response.

→ Offer one concrete act of service that matches the patience or steadiness this passage commends.

Prayer

Father, thank You for speaking clearly in Luke 15:3-5. In this passage You bring seeking mercy that refuses to leave the lost where they wandered into the open through If he has a hundred sheep and has lost one of them. Lord Jesus, keep us from reading these words as distant history only, and press them into our ordinary obedience today. Where we resist the truth highlighted in this reflection, bring repentance and renewed trust. Keep us near Your word, and do not let ordinary pressure turn us away from humble obedience. Holy Spirit, take what we have seen in the exposition and turn it into worship instead of mere information. Teach us to remember that Luke 15:3-5 opens with a

Luke 15:6-8 - Does not light a lamp and sweep the house and search carefully until she finds it

Timeless Wisdom

Resolved, never to do anything which I should be afraid to do if it were the last hour of my life.

- Jonathan Edwards, Resolutions

Scripture Reading

Luke 15:6-8 (NASB)

And when he comes home, he calls together his friends and his neighbors, saying to them, 'Rejoice with me, for I have found my sheep which was lost!' I tell you that in the same way, there will be more joy in heaven over one sinner who repents than over ninety-nine righteous persons who need no repentance.

"Or what woman, if she has ten silver coins and loses one coin, does not light a lamp and sweep the house and search carefully until she finds it?"

Reflection

Luke 15:6-8 opens with a scene marked by heavenly joy over one repentant sinner. The text does not ask the reader to admire the moment from a distance. The passage puts one clear scene in front of us: Does not light a lamp and sweep the house and search carefully until she finds it. We should stay with that scene before we rush to a slogan. Because this is narrative material, the theology arrives through events, actions, and speech rather than detached maxims. That keeps the reading honest. The wider context matters too. Luke 15:6-8 belongs to a larger movement in which Jesus is being received, resisted, watched, and answered. So the burden here is heavenly joy over one repentant sinner. The theological lane is the joy of God and heaven over repentance dwarfs the stingy calculations of religious pride. The passage stays concrete through When he comes home he calls together and does, not, light. Failure is not minimized here; it is remembered, named, and turned into grief that can no longer pretend innocence. What we see in Luke 15:6-8 shows how people respond when Jesus stands near and the cost of discipleship is no longer theoretical. The point is not bare information. It presses into honest repentance instead of defensive self-justification. We should not drift into generic encouragement detached from the scene. We should let the passage name the pressure point for the day. If the scene is shaped by Does not light a lamp and sweep the house and search carefully until she finds it, then obedience today should answer that same pressure point. Where the text exposes fear, we should admit failure quickly and return to the Lord. Where it honors devotion, we should practice shared joy in repentance that celebrates grace instead of minimizing what heaven itself delights in. Where it reveals Jesus clearly, we should pursue grief that returns to truth instead of hiding rather than delay. That keeps the day under the authority of Scripture. Strong exposition stays close to the text. It does not chase a clever slogan. It lets the details do their

Still Before God

- Sit with Luke 15:6-8 for two quiet minutes. Read the scene of heavenly joy over one repentant sinner slowly and let it settle before you move on.
- Where does this passage call for shared joy in repentance that celebrates grace instead of minimizing what heaven itself delights in today?
- Stay for one more minute and answer God with one honest sentence of confession, courage, or repentance before continuing.

Walk It Out

Because Luke 15:6-8 calls for shared joy in repentance that celebrates grace instead of minimizing what heaven itself delights in today:

- Confess one recent failure honestly to God without self-defense.
- Return to one neglected act of obedience that Luke 15:6-8 brings back to mind.

Prayer

Father, thank You for speaking clearly in Luke 15:6-8. In this passage You bring heavenly joy over one repentant sinner into the open through Does not light a lamp and sweep the house and search carefully until she finds it. Lord Jesus, keep us from reading these words as distant history only, and press them into our ordinary obedience today. Where we resist the truth highlighted in this reflection, bring repentance and renewed trust. Keep us from Peter's collapse of courage, and teach us to remember Your word before fear becomes denial. Holy Spirit, take what we have seen in the exposition and turn it into worship instead of mere information. Teach us to remember that Luke 15:6-8 opens with a scene marked by heavenly joy over one repentant sinner. Guard our speech from haste, our work

Luke 15:9-10 - There is joy in the presence of the angels of God over one sinner who repents

Timeless Wisdom

Men will never find a remedy for their miseries until, forgetting their own merits, by trusting to which they only deceive themselves, they have learned to betake themselves to the free mercy of God.

- John Calvin, Commentary on Psalms - Volume 1

Scripture Reading

Luke 15:9-10 (NASB)

When she has found it, she calls together her friends and neighbors, saying, 'Rejoice with me, for I have found the coin which I had lost!' In the same way, I tell you, there is joy in the presence of the angels of God over one sinner who repents."

Reflection

Luke 15:9-10 opens with a scene marked by heavenly joy over one repentant sinner. The text does not ask the reader to admire the moment from a distance. The passage puts one clear scene in front of us: There is joy in the presence of the angels of God over one sinner who repents. We should stay with that scene before we rush to a slogan. Because this is narrative material, the theology arrives through events, actions, and speech rather than detached maxims. That keeps the reading honest. The wider context matters too. Luke 15:9-10 belongs to a larger movement in which Jesus is being received, resisted, watched, and answered. So the burden here is heavenly joy over one repentant sinner. The theological lane is the joy of God and heaven over repentance dwarfs the stingy calculations of religious pride. The passage stays concrete through When she has found it she calls and joy, presence, angels. Failure is not minimized here; it is remembered, named, and turned into grief that can no longer pretend innocence. What we see in Luke 15:9-10 shows how people respond when Jesus stands near and the cost of discipleship is no longer theoretical. The point is not bare information. It presses into honest repentance instead of defensive self-justification. We should not drift into generic encouragement detached from the scene. We should let the passage name the pressure point for the day. If the scene is shaped by There is joy in the presence of the angels of God over one sinner who repents, then obedience today should answer that same pressure point. Where the text exposes fear, we should admit failure quickly and return to the Lord. Where it honors devotion, we should practice shared joy in repentance that celebrates grace instead of minimizing what heaven itself delights in. Where it reveals Jesus clearly, we should pursue grief that returns to truth instead of hiding rather than delay. That keeps the day under the authority of Scripture. Strong exposition stays close to the text. It does not chase a clever slogan. It lets the details do their work on the conscience. That kind of reading slows us down. It teaches us to listen before we react. It also keeps prayer and application

Still Before God

- Sit with Luke 15:9-10 for two quiet minutes. Read the scene of heavenly joy over one repentant sinner slowly and let it settle before you move on.
- Where does this passage call for shared joy in repentance that celebrates grace instead of minimizing what heaven itself delights in today?
- Stay for one more minute and answer God with one honest sentence of confession, courage, or repentance before continuing.

Walk It Out

Because Luke 15:9-10 calls for shared joy in repentance that celebrates grace instead of minimizing what heaven itself delights in today:

- Confess one recent failure honestly to God without self-defense.
- Return to one neglected act of obedience that Luke 15:9-10 brings back to mind.

Prayer

Father, thank You for speaking clearly in Luke 15:9-10. In this passage You bring heavenly joy over one repentant sinner into the open through There is joy in the presence of the angels of God over one sinner who repents. Lord Jesus, keep us from reading these words as distant history only, and press them into our ordinary obedience today. Where we resist the truth highlighted in this reflection, bring repentance and renewed trust. Keep us from Peter's collapse of courage, and teach us to remember Your word before fear becomes denial. Holy Spirit, take what we have seen in the exposition and turn it into worship instead of mere information. Teach us to remember that Luke 15:9-10 opens with a scene marked by heavenly joy over one repentant sinner. Guard our speech from haste, our work from pride,

Luke 15:11-13 - The younger son gathered everything together and went on a journey into a distant country

Timeless Wisdom

If you had as much guilt lying on each of your souls as all the wicked men in the world, and all the damned souls in hell; yet if you come to God for mercy, sensible of your own vileness, and seeking pardon only through the free mercy of God in Christ, you would not need to be afraid.

- Jonathan Edwards, Select Sermons

Scripture Reading

Luke 15:11-13 (NASB)

And He said, "A man had two sons. The younger of them said to his father, 'Father, give me the share of the estate that falls to me.' So he divided his wealth between them. And not many days later, the younger son gathered everything together and went on a journey into a distant country, and there he squandered his estate with loose living.

Reflection

Luke 15:11-13 opens with a scene marked by rebellious desire that mistakes distance from the father for freedom. The text does not ask the reader to admire the moment from a distance. The passage puts one clear scene in front of us: The younger son gathered everything together and went on a journey into a distant country. We should stay with that scene before we rush to a slogan. Because this is narrative material, the theology arrives through events, actions, and speech rather than detached maxims. That keeps the reading honest. The wider context matters too. Luke 15:11-13 belongs to a larger movement in which Jesus is being received, resisted, watched, and answered. So the burden here is rebellious desire that mistakes distance from the father for freedom. The theological lane is sinful independence spends the father's gifts while rejecting the father's presence. The passage stays concrete through He said "A man had two sons and younger, son, gathered. What we see in Luke 15:11-13 shows how people respond when Jesus stands near and the cost of discipleship is no longer theoretical. The point is not bare information. It presses into faithful response instead of vague admiration. We should not drift into generic encouragement detached from the scene. We should let the passage name the pressure point for the day. If the scene is shaped by The younger son gathered everything together and went on a journey into a distant country, then obedience today should answer that same pressure point. Where the text exposes fear, we should answer the word with concrete obedience. Where it honors devotion, we should practice honest repentance that stops calling self-ruled distance from God a form of freedom. Where it reveals Jesus clearly, we should pursue steady trust in the ordinary places of life rather than delay. That keeps the day under the authority of Scripture. Strong exposition stays close to the text. It does not chase a clever slogan. It lets the details do their work on the conscience. That kind of

Still Before God

- Sit with Luke 15:11-13 for two quiet minutes. Read the scene of rebellious desire that mistakes distance from the father for freedom slowly and let it settle before you move on.
- Where does this passage call for honest repentance that stops calling self-ruled distance from God a form of freedom today?
- Stay for one more minute and answer God with one honest sentence of trust, repentance, or gratitude before continuing.

Walk It Out

Because Luke 15:11-13 calls for honest repentance that stops calling self-ruled distance from God a form of freedom today:

→ Write one sentence naming how Luke 15:11-13 presses on the scene of The younger son gathered everything together and went on a journey into a distant country.

→ Name one place where honest repentance that stops calling self-ruled distance from God a form of freedom should change the way you listen, speak, or act today.

Prayer

Father, thank You for speaking clearly in Luke 15:11-13. In this passage You bring rebellious desire that mistakes distance from the father for freedom into the open through The younger son gathered everything together and went on a journey into a distant country. Lord Jesus, keep us from reading these words as distant history only, and press them into our ordinary obedience today. Where we resist the truth highlighted in this reflection, bring repentance and renewed trust. Keep us near Your word, and do not let ordinary pressure turn us away from humble obedience. Holy Spirit, take what we have seen in the exposition and turn it into worship instead of mere information.

Luke 15:14-16 - He would have gladly filled his stomach with the pods that the swine were eating

Timeless Wisdom

Be killing sin or it will be killing you.

- John Owen, Of the Mortification of Sin in Believers

Scripture Reading

Luke 15:14-16 (NASB)

Now when he had spent everything, a severe famine occurred in that country, and he began to be impoverished. So he went and hired himself out to one of the citizens of that country, and he sent him into his fields to feed swine. And he would have gladly filled his stomach with the pods that the swine were eating, and no one was giving anything to him.

Reflection

Luke 15:14-16 opens with a scene marked by the emptiness and humiliation that finally expose rebellion. The text does not ask the reader to admire the moment from a distance. The passage puts one clear scene in front of us: He would have gladly filled his stomach with the pods that the swine were eating. We should stay with that scene before we rush to a slogan. Because this is narrative material, the theology arrives through events, actions, and speech rather than detached maxims. That keeps the reading honest. The wider context matters too. Luke 15:14-16 belongs to a larger movement in which Jesus is being received, resisted, watched, and answered. So the burden here is the emptiness and humiliation that finally expose rebellion. The theological lane is the far country cannot sustain the sinner; ruin exposes the lie that rebellion can nourish the soul. The passage stays concrete through Now when he had spent everything and gladly, filled, his. What we see in Luke 15:14-16 shows how people respond when Jesus stands near and the cost of discipleship is no longer theoretical. The point is not bare information. It presses into faithful response instead of vague admiration. We should not drift into generic encouragement detached from the scene. We should let the passage name the pressure point for the day. If the scene is shaped by He would have gladly filled his stomach with the pods that the swine were eating, then obedience today should answer that same pressure point. Where the text exposes fear, we should answer the word with concrete obedience. Where it honors devotion, we should practice sobriety about sin's emptiness that stops romanticizing paths which finally leave people starving. Where it reveals Jesus clearly, we should pursue steady trust in the ordinary places of life rather than delay. That keeps the day under the authority of Scripture. Strong exposition stays close to the text. It does not chase a clever slogan. It lets the details do their work on the conscience. That kind of reading slows us down. It teaches us to listen before we react. It also keeps prayer and application from drifting away from the passage. The passage sustains courage because

Still Before God

- Sit with Luke 15:14-16 for two quiet minutes. Read the scene of the emptiness and humiliation that finally expose rebellion slowly and let it settle before you move on.
- Where does this passage call for sobriety about sin's emptiness that stops romanticizing paths which finally leave people starving today?
- Stay for one more minute and answer God with one honest sentence of trust, repentance, or gratitude before continuing.

Walk It Out

Because Luke 15:14-16 calls for sobriety about sin's emptiness that stops romanticizing paths which finally leave people starving today:

- Before your next decision, pause and ask how Luke 15:14-16 should shape your response.
- Offer one concrete act of service that matches the patience or steadiness this passage commends.

Prayer

Father, thank You for speaking clearly in Luke 15:14-16. In this passage You bring the emptiness and humiliation that finally expose rebellion into the open through He would have gladly filled his stomach with the pods that the swine were eating. Lord Jesus, keep us from reading these words as distant history only, and press them into our ordinary obedience today. Where we resist the truth highlighted in this reflection, bring repentance and renewed trust. Keep us near Your word, and do not let ordinary pressure turn us away from humble obedience. Holy Spirit, take what we have seen in the exposition and turn it into worship instead of mere information. Teach us to remember that Luke 15:14-16 opens with a scene marked by the emptiness and humiliation that finally expose rebellion. Guard our

Luke 15:17-18 - 'How many of my father's hired men have more than enough bread'

Timeless Wisdom

Prayer is not overcoming God's reluctance, but laying hold of His willingness.

- Martin Luther, The Sovereignty of God

Scripture Reading

Luke 15:17-18 (NASB)

But when he came to his senses, he said, 'How many of my father's hired men have more than enough bread, but I am dying here with hunger! I will get up and go to my father, and will say to him, "Father, I have sinned against heaven, and in your sight;

Reflection

Luke 15:17-18 opens with a scene marked by repentance that comes to its senses and returns honestly. The text does not ask the reader to admire the moment from a distance. The passage puts one clear scene in front of us: 'How many of my father's hired men have more than enough bread. We should stay with that scene before we rush to a slogan. Because this is narrative material, the theology arrives through

Still Before God

- Sit with Luke 15:17-18 for two quiet minutes. Read the scene of repentance that comes to its senses and returns honestly slowly and let it settle before you move on.
- Where does this passage call for plainspoken repentance that rises and returns without bargaining away the truth about sin today?
- Stay for one more minute and answer God with one honest sentence of confession, courage, or repentance before continuing.

Walk It Out

Because Luke 15:17-18 calls for plainspoken repentance that rises and returns without bargaining away the truth about sin today:

- Confess one recent failure honestly to God without self-defense.
- Return to one neglected act of obedience that Luke 15:17-18 brings back to mind.

Prayer

Father, thank You for speaking clearly in Luke 15:17-18. In this passage You bring repentance that comes to its senses and returns honestly into the open through ‘How many of my father’s hired men have more than enough bread. Lord Jesus, keep us from reading these words as distant history only, and press them into our ordinary obedience today. Where we resist the truth highlighted in this reflection, bring repentance and renewed trust. Keep us from Peter’s collapse of courage, and teach us to remember Your word before fear becomes denial. Holy Spirit, take what we have seen in the exposition and turn it into worship instead of mere information. Teach us to remember that Luke 15:17-18 opens with a scene marked by repentance that comes to its senses and returns honestly. Guard our speech from haste, our work from pride, and our choices from

Luke 15:19-21 - I have sinned against heaven and in your sight

Timeless Wisdom

God loves the music of prayer, but does not always let us hear from him at once; but in due season gives an answer of peace.

- Thomas Watson, The Ten Commandments

Scripture Reading

Luke 15:19-21 (NASB)

I am no longer worthy to be called your son; make me as one of your hired men.”’ So he got up and came to his father. But while he was still a long way off, his father saw him and felt compassion for him, and ran and embraced him and kissed him. And the son said to him, ‘Father, I have sinned against heaven and in your sight; I am no longer worthy to be called your son.’

Reflection

Luke 15:19-21 opens with a scene marked by repentance that comes to its senses and returns honestly. The text does not ask the reader to admire the moment from a distance. The passage puts one clear scene in front of us: I have sinned against heaven and in the sight. We should stay with that scene before we rush to a slogan. Because this is narrative material, the theology arrives through events, actions, and speech rather than detached maxims. That keeps the reading honest. The wider context matters too. Luke 15:19-21 belongs to a larger movement in which Jesus is being received, resisted, watched, and answered. So the burden here is repentance that comes to its senses and returns honestly. The theological lane is true repentance names sin plainly, abandons excuses, and turns back toward the father. The passage stays concrete through I am no longer worthy to be and sinned, against, heaven. Failure is not minimized here; it is remembered, named, and turned into grief that can no longer pretend innocence. What we see in Luke 15:19-21 shows how people respond when Jesus stands near and the cost of discipleship is no longer theoretical. The point is not bare information. It presses into honest repentance instead of defensive self-justification. We should not drift into generic encouragement detached from the scene. We should let the passage name the pressure point for the day. If the scene is shaped by I have sinned against heaven and in the sight, then obedience today should answer that same pressure point. Where the text exposes fear, we should admit failure quickly and return to the Lord. Where it honors devotion, we should practice plainspoken repentance that rises and returns without bargaining away the truth about sin. Where it reveals Jesus clearly, we should pursue grief that returns to truth instead of hiding rather than delay. That keeps the day under the authority of Scripture. Strong exposition stays close to the text. It does not chase a clever slogan. It lets the details do their work on the conscience. That kind of reading slows us down. It teaches us to listen before we react. It also keeps prayer and application from drifting away

Still Before God

- Sit with Luke 15:19-21 for two quiet minutes. Read the scene of repentance that comes to its senses and returns honestly slowly and let it settle before you move on.
- Where does this passage call for plainspoken repentance that rises and returns without bargaining away the truth about sin today?
- Stay for one more minute and answer God with one honest sentence of confession, courage, or repentance before continuing.

Walk It Out

Because Luke 15:19-21 calls for plainspoken repentance that rises and returns without bargaining away the truth about sin today:

- Confess one recent failure honestly to God without self-defense.
- Return to one neglected act of obedience that Luke 15:19-21 brings back to mind.

Prayer

Father, thank You for speaking clearly in Luke 15:19-21. In this passage You bring repentance that comes to its senses and returns honestly into the open through I have sinned against heaven and in the sight. Lord Jesus, keep us from reading these words as distant history only, and press them into our ordinary obedience today. Where we resist the truth highlighted in this reflection, bring repentance and renewed trust. Keep us from Peter's collapse of courage, and teach us to remember Your word before fear becomes denial. Holy Spirit, take what we have seen in the exposition and turn it into worship instead of mere information. Teach us to remember that Luke 15:19-21 opens with a scene marked by repentance that comes to its senses and returns honestly. Guard our speech from haste, our work from pride, and our choices from whatever would pull us away from honest repentance

Luke 15:22-24 - Put a ring on his hand and sandals on his feet

Timeless Wisdom

When you prayest, rather let your heart be without words than your words without heart.

- John Bunyan, A Discourse on Prayer

Scripture Reading

Luke 15:22-24 (NASB)

But the father said to his slaves, 'Quickly bring out the best robe and put it on him, and put a ring on his hand and sandals on his feet; and bring the fattened calf, kill it, and let us eat and celebrate; for this son of mine was dead and has come to life again; he was lost and has been found.' And they began to celebrate.

Reflection

Luke 15:22-24 opens with a scene marked by the father's compassionate welcome outruns the returning sinner. The text does not ask the reader to admire the moment from a distance. The passage puts one clear scene in front of us: Put a ring on his hand and sandals on his feet. We should stay with that scene before we rush to a slogan.

Still Before God

- Sit with Luke 15:22-24 for two quiet minutes. Read the scene of the father's compassionate welcome outruns the returning sinner slowly and let it settle before you move on.
- Where does this passage call for resting in the father's restoring mercy instead of trying to earn a place back through self-humbling performance today?
- Stay for one more minute and answer God with one honest sentence of trust, repentance, or gratitude before continuing.

Walk It Out

Because Luke 15:22-24 calls for resting in the father's restoring mercy instead of trying to earn a place back through self-humbling performance today:

- Write one sentence naming how Luke 15:22-24 presses on the scene of Put a ring on his hand and sandals on his feet.
- Name one place where resting in the father's restoring mercy instead of trying to earn a place back through self-humbling performance should change the way you listen, speak, or act today.

Prayer

Father, thank You for speaking clearly in Luke 15:22-24. In this passage You bring the father's compassionate welcome outruns the returning sinner into the open through Put a ring on his hand and sandals on his feet. Lord Jesus, keep us from reading these words as distant history only, and press them into our ordinary obedience today. Where we resist the truth highlighted in this reflection, bring repentance and renewed trust. Keep us near Your word, and do not let ordinary pressure turn us away from humble obedience. Holy Spirit, take what we have seen in the exposition and turn it into worship instead of fleeing from it. Thank You for Your word, and for Your love.

Week 2 · Day 10

Luke 15:25-26 - He summoned one of the servants and began inquiring what these things could be

Timeless Wisdom

Without knowledge of self there is no knowledge of God.

- John Calvin, Institutes of the Christian Religion

Scripture Reading

Luke 15:25-26 (NASB)

“Now his older son was in the field, and when he came and approached the house, he heard music and dancing. And he summoned one of the servants and began inquiring what these things could be.

Reflection

Luke 15:25-26 opens with a scene marked by self-righteous resentment that refuses the joy of grace. The text does not ask the reader to admire the moment from a distance. The passage puts one clear scene in front of us: He summoned one of the servants and began inquiring what these things could be. We should stay with that scene before we rush to a slogan. Because this is narrative material, the theology arrives through

Still Before God

- Sit with Luke 15:25-26 for two quiet minutes. Read the scene of self-righteous resentment that refuses the joy of grace slowly and let it settle before you move on.
- Where does this passage call for repentance from resentful self-righteousness that measures grace like wages instead of receiving it as family mercy today?
- Stay for one more minute and answer God with one honest sentence of trust, repentance, or gratitude before continuing.

Walk It Out

Because Luke 15:25-26 calls for repentance from resentful self-righteousness that measures grace like wages instead of receiving it as family mercy today:

→ Before your next decision, pause and ask how Luke 15:25-26 should shape your response.

→ Offer one concrete act of service that matches the patience or steadiness this passage commends.

Prayer

Father, thank You for speaking clearly in Luke 15:25-26. In this passage You bring self-righteous resentment that refuses the joy of grace into the open through He summoned one of the servants and began inquiring what these things could be. Lord Jesus, keep us from reading these words as distant history only, and press them into our ordinary obedience today. Where we resist the truth highlighted in this reflection, bring repentance and renewed trust. Keep us near Your word, and do not let ordinary pressure turn us away from humble obedience. Holy Spirit, take what we have seen in the exposition and turn it into worship instead of mere information. Teach us to

Luke 15:27-29 - Many years I have been serving you and I have never neglected a command of yours

Timeless Wisdom

Resolved, never to do any thing, which I should be afraid to do if it were the last hour of my life.

- Jonathan Edwards, Resolutions

Scripture Reading

Luke 15:27-29 (NASB)

And he said to him, 'Your brother has come, and your father has killed the fattened calf because he has received him back safe and sound.' But he became angry and was not willing to go in; and his father came out and began pleading with him. But he answered and said to his father, 'Look! For so many years I have been serving you and I have never neglected a command of yours; and yet you have never given me a young goat, so that I might celebrate with my friends;

Reflection

Luke 15:27-29 opens with a scene marked by self-righteous resentment that refuses the joy of grace. The text does not ask the reader to admire the moment from a distance. The passage puts one clear scene in front of us: Many years I have been serving the hearer and I have never neglected a command of yours. We should stay with that scene before we rush to a slogan. Because this is narrative material, the theology arrives through events, actions, and speech rather than detached maxims. That keeps the reading honest. The wider context matters too. Luke 15:27-29 belongs to a larger movement in which Jesus is being received, resisted, watched, and answered. So the burden here is self-righteous resentment that refuses the joy of grace. The theological lane is religious pride can remain near the father's house while hating the father's mercy and joy. The passage stays concrete through He said to him 'the brother has and many, years, been. What we see in Luke 15:27-29 shows how people respond when Jesus stands near and the cost of discipleship is no longer theoretical. The point is not bare information. It presses into faithful response instead of vague admiration. We should not drift into generic encouragement detached from the scene. We should let the passage name the pressure point for the day. If the scene is shaped by Many years I have been serving the hearer and I have never neglected a command of yours, then obedience today should answer that same pressure point. Where the text exposes fear, we should answer the word with concrete obedience. Where it honors devotion, we should practice repentance from resentful self-righteousness that measures grace like wages instead of receiving it as family mercy. Where it reveals Jesus clearly, we should pursue steady trust in the ordinary places of life rather than delay. That keeps the day under the authority of Scripture. Strong exposition stays close to the text. It does not chase a clever slogan. It lets the details do their work on the conscience. That kind of reading slows us down. It teaches us to

Still Before God

- Sit with Luke 15:27-29 for two quiet minutes. Read the scene of self-righteous resentment that refuses the joy of grace slowly and let it settle before you move on.
- Where does this passage call for repentance from resentful self-righteousness that measures grace like wages instead of receiving it as family mercy today?
- Stay for one more minute and answer God with one honest sentence of trust, repentance, or gratitude before continuing.

Walk It Out

Because Luke 15:27-29 calls for repentance from resentful self-righteousness that measures grace like wages instead of receiving it as family mercy today:

- Name one place where you have been trying to control the outcome, and entrust that concern to God in prayer.
- End the day by recording one evidence of God's goodness you noticed in work, rest, or relationships.

Prayer

Father, thank You for speaking clearly in Luke 15:27-29. In this passage You bring self-righteous resentment that refuses the joy of grace into the open through Many years I have been serving the hearer and I have never neglected a command of yours. Lord Jesus, keep us from reading these words as distant history only, and press them into our ordinary obedience today. Where we resist the truth highlighted in this reflection, bring repentance and renewed trust. Keep us near Your word, and do not let ordinary pressure turn us away from humble obedience. Holy Spirit, take what we have seen in the exposition and turn it into worship instead of mere information. Teach us to

Luke 15:30-32 - This brother of yours was dead and has begun to live

Timeless Wisdom

Mercy more overflows in God, than sin in us.

- Thomas Watson, The Ten Commandments

Scripture Reading

Luke 15:30-32 (NASB)

but when this son of yours came, who has devoured your wealth with prostitutes, you killed the fattened calf for him.’ And he said to him, ‘Son, you have always been with me, and all that is mine is yours. But we had to celebrate and rejoice, for this brother of yours was dead and has begun to live, and was lost and has been found.’ ”

Reflection

Luke 15:30-32 opens with a scene marked by the father's appeal to share his joy instead of standing outside in pride. The text does not ask the reader to admire the moment from a distance. The passage puts one clear scene in front of us: This brother of yours was dead and has begun to live. We should stay with that scene before we rush to a slogan. Because this is narrative material, the theology arrives through

Still Before God

- Sit with Luke 15:30-32 for two quiet minutes. Read the scene of the father's appeal to share his joy instead of standing outside in pride slowly and let it settle before you move on.
- Where does this passage call for coming inside the joy of grace by receiving the father's generosity instead of standing outside with off ended pride today?
- Stay for one more minute and answer God with one honest sentence of trust, repentance, or gratitude before continuing.

Walk It Out

Because Luke 15:30-32 calls for coming inside the joy of grace by receiving the father's generosity instead of standing outside with off ended pride today:

- Speak one truthful and encouraging sentence to someone today as a direct response to Luke 15:30-32.
- Set aside ten minutes to practice the obedience this reflection emphasized instead of postponing it.

Prayer

Father, thank You for speaking clearly in Luke 15:30-32. In this passage You bring the father's appeal to share his joy instead of standing outside in pride into the open through This brother of yours was dead and has begun to live. Lord Jesus, keep us from reading these words as distant history only, and press them into our ordinary obedience today. Where we resist the truth highlighted in this reflection, bring repentance and renewed trust. Keep us near Your word, and do not let ordinary pressure turn us away from humble obedience. Holy Spirit, take what we have seen in the exposition and turn it into worship instead of mere information. Teach us to

Footnotes

1. John Wesley, Sermons and Tracts, (Nampa, ID: Wesley Center Online, 1770), Section 4.
2. John Bunyan, A Discourse on Prayer, (Grand Rapids, MI: Christian Classics Ethereal Library, 1662), Of Prayer.
3. Jonathan Edwards, Resolutions, (Grand Rapids, MI: Christian Classics Ethereal Library, 1722), Resolution 7.
4. John Calvin, Commentary on Psalms - Volume 1, (Grand Rapids, MI: Christian Classics Ethereal Library, 1845), Psalm 6:4.
5. Jonathan Edwards, Select Sermons, (Grand Rapids, MI: Christian Classics Ethereal Library, 1734), Application.
6. John Owen, Of the Mortification of Sin in Believers, (Grand Rapids, MI: Christian Classics Ethereal Library, 1656), Part I, chap. 5.
7. Martin Luther, The Sovereignty of God, (Grand Rapids, MI: Christian Classics Ethereal Library, 1918), The Value of This Doctrine: Prayer.
8. Thomas Watson, The Ten Commandments, (Grand Rapids, MI: Christian Classics Ethereal Library, 1692), Use ten. God shows mercy in hearing our prayers.
9. John Bunyan, A Discourse on Prayer, (Grand Rapids, MI: Christian Classics Ethereal Library, 1662), Of Prayer. (Language modernized by AI)
10. John Calvin, Institutes of the Christian Religion, (Grand Rapids, MI: Christian Classics Ethereal Library, 1536), Book I, chap. 1, sec. 1.

11. Jonathan Edwards, Resolutions, (Grand Rapids, MI: Christian Classics Ethereal Library, 1722), Resolution 7.

12. Thomas Watson, The Ten Commandments, (Grand Rapids, MI: Christian Classics Ethereal Library, 1692), Use two. Hope in God's mercies.

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